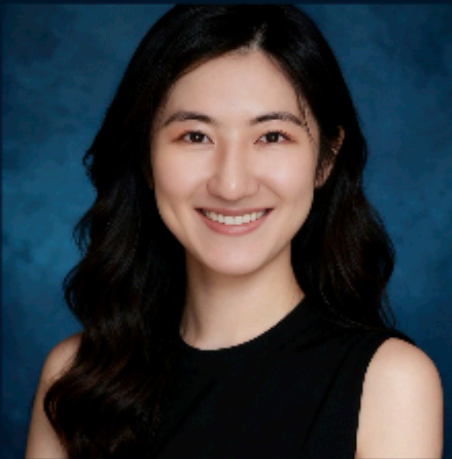


YINGYI KONG



Yingyi Kong has always possessed an innate curiosity to figure out how the world works, but her journey to the forefront of Computer Science was a deliberate and bold evolution. Rooted in a background of Translation and Interpreting, Yingyi spent her early academic years bridging human languages, developing a meticulous eye for structure and nuance. After enrolling at Northeastern University, this linguistic precision found a new home in the logic of code, where she quickly transitioned from analyzing text to architecting complex distributed systems. Her technical "debut" emerged through projects like FoodWise AI—a masterful blend of rigorous backend engineering and intuitive design that turns complex multi-agent AI into simple, daily utility. Today, Yingyi is defined not just by her full-stack capabilities, but by her unique philosophy: she is a builder who carries herself with the discipline of an engineer and the open mind of an explorer, creating solutions that are as stable as they are meaningful.

Personal Portfolio Website

Prepared for: Web Development Personal Website Project

Prepared by: Yingyi Kong

January 20, 2026

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DESIGN DOCUMENT

Project Description

This project is a personal portfolio website designed to showcase my dual background in Translation/Interpreting and Computer Science. The goal is to present myself not just as a developer, but as a "builder with the discipline of an engineer and the open mind of an explorer."

The site serves as a central hub for my professional identity, featuring a curated selection of my technical projects (such as "FoodWise AI" and "SmartBill") and providing a clear narrative of my academic journey at Northeastern University. The design philosophy is "Editorial Minimalism"—using large typography, high-contrast aesthetics (Dark/Light modes), and plenty of whitespace to let the content breathe.

Differentiation (Creative Component): Unlike standard template portfolios, this site features a custom "Interactive Theme & Project Showcase". The site utilizes a custom JavaScript module to toggle between a "Night" (Dark Blue) and "Day" (Warm Beige) mode that doesn't just invert colors, but changes the mood of the imagery and typography weight. Additionally, the project grid uses a custom ES6-based hover effect to reveal details dynamically.

User Personas

Persona A: "Alex - The Tech Recruiter"

Role: Technical Recruiter at a mid-to-large tech company.

Motivation: Alex has 30 seconds to decide if Yingyi is worth an interview. He needs to verify technical skills (React, Node.js, etc.) and see proof of work.

Frustrations: Cluttered websites, hard-to-find contact info, broken links, and portfolios that look like generic templates.

Goals: Quickly find the "Projects" section, view a live demo or GitHub repo, and locate the Resume/Contact info.

Persona B: "Sarah - The Senior Engineer / Team Lead"

Role: Senior Software Engineer looking for a Summer Intern.

Motivation: Sarah wants to know how Yingyi thinks. She cares less about the flashiness of the site and more about the quality of the project documentation and the "Why" behind the code.

Frustrations: Portfolios that are all style and no substance; lack of context on what the candidate actually contributed to a project.

Goals: Read the "Why I built it" section of specific projects (e.g., FoodWise AI) to understand the engineering challenges Yingyi solved.

User Stories

Story 1: The Quick Scan (Recruiter Flow)

"As Alex (the recruiter), I land on the homepage and am immediately greeted by a clear bio that tells me Yingyi is a CS student with a unique background. I notice the navigation bar at the top right. I click 'WORK' and am smooth-scrolled to the project gallery. I see the 'FoodWise AI' card, click it, and am taken to a detailed project page. I see a 'GitHub' link immediately. Satisfied that the code exists, I scroll to the footer and click the email link to send an interview request."

Story 2: The Deep Dive (Engineer Flow)

"As Sarah (the engineer), I want to see if Yingyi understands full-stack concepts. I toggle the site theme to 'Light Mode' because I prefer reading on a light background. I read the 'About' section and am intrigued by her transition from Translation to Code. I navigate to the 'SmartBill' project page. I read the 'Technical Challenges' section to see how she handled the multi-agent AI implementation. The clean layout makes it easy to read without distractions."

DESIGN DOCUMENT

Design Mockups

Color Palette:

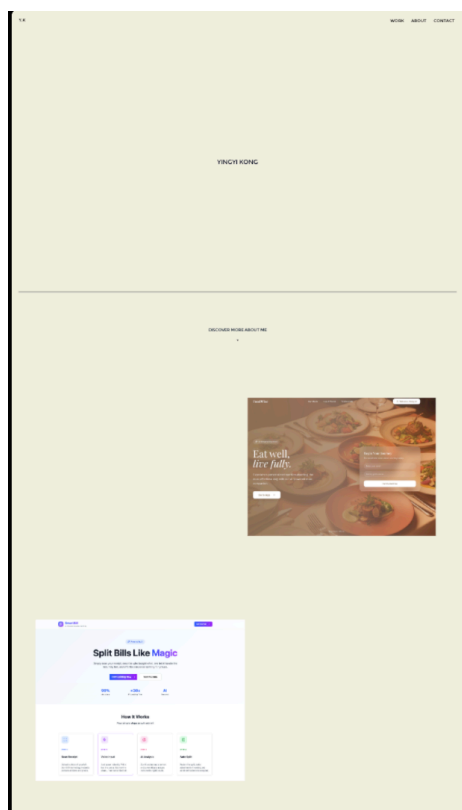
- Navy Blue (#04182C)
- Beige/Cream (#F0EEDE)

Typography: Sans-serif, clean, large font weights for the "Y.K." footer element to create a strong brand identity.

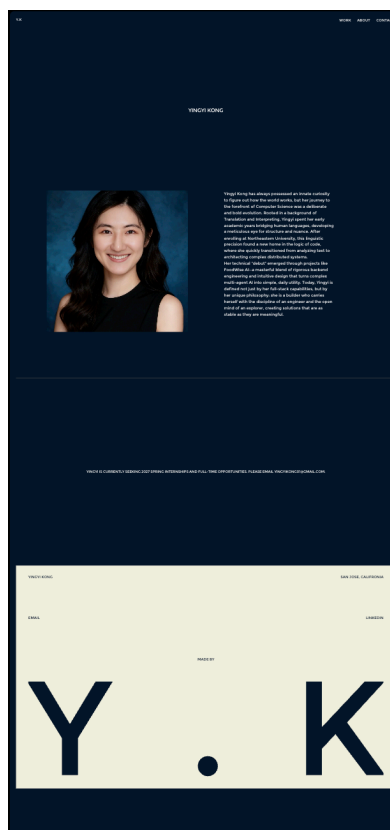
Layout: CSS Grid / Flexbox based layout.

- Hero Section: Centered bio with portrait.
- Projects: Two-column grid layout.
- Footer: Oversized typography acting as a graphical element.

1. The Landing Page (Home)



2. The Portfolio Gallery (Work)



3. Project Detail View

PROJECT NAME
YINCHI KONG

HEADING 2
TIME

Why I built it:

GITHUB LINK

Team

Quick Look

